better be hanged before the Congress (Karachi) Session, not after it"[4] could hardly be expected to secure commutation of the death sentences of Bhagat Singh and his comrades'.[5]

One original source which has curiously been all too often overlooked is that of the Indian nationalist Subhas Chandra Bose's *The Indian Struggle (1920–1942)*, which he wrote while in exile in Europe. Described by Sisir Bose and Sugata Bose as a 'major political study of the movement for independence in which he himself was a leading participant',[6] the book was immediately banned by the secretary of state for India, Sir Samuel Hoare, on grounds that it 'tended generally to encourage methods of terrorism and direct action'.[7] That did not stop *The Manchester Guardian* from bestowing upon it an even better accolade when it said of it that '[t]his is perhaps the most interesting book which has yet been written by an Indian politician on Indian politics' and that it 'is as nearly fair to all parties and everyone else [as] can reasonably be expected of an active politician'.[8] It is for this reason why what this account has to say of Bhagat Singh is so significant. Bose gives a stirring description of the time in 1929 when in India '[t]here was an under-current of revolutionary activity' together with 'an unrest in the Labour world which extended to every part of the country' as well as 'an awakening among the middle-class youths which was manifest everywhere'. He explains how '[t]he visible expression' of this 'was afforded by two incidents which occurred at Lahore and at Delhi', the first being the assassination of the police inspector, Mr Saunders, who was believed to be responsible for the attack on Lala Lajpat Rai in 1928, and the second being the throwing of the bomb in the assembly in Delhi by Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt,[9] which led to their arrest, detention and trial by the authorities.

This was the time of the Gandhi–Irwin Pact 1931 which was important because it marked the end of the period of civil disobedience, known as satyagraha, that Gandhi had invoked with the Salt March against British Rule during the months of March and April 1930, and which led to his incarceration for illegally making salt. By the end of that year, tens of thousands of his followers were arrested. Under the glare of international